

LIVEDROP ARENA

Platform Guide & Operating Manual

A step-by-step walkthrough of the research admin panel and the streamer partner portal — for researchers, supervisors, and stream partners.

Persuasion Cues in Viewer Reward Recruitment — a livestream-gaming viewer-reward recruitment study

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PART ONE

Researcher Admin Panel

Everything a researcher needs to run the study day-to-day: tracking recruitment, following up with participants, running the debrief and interview pipeline, and exporting data for analysis.

1. Logging In

Go to the platform's login page and sign in with your researcher account email and password.

- 1 Enter your email and password, then click **Log In**.
- 2 The button shows a loading state while it checks your credentials — this can take a moment.
- 3 On success, you'll see a confirmation message and be redirected automatically to the [Dashboard](#).
- 4 On a wrong password, an error message appears directly on the form — you can correct it and try again without reloading the page.

TIP — If you forget your password or need a new researcher account created, contact the platform administrator directly — there is currently no self-service password reset.

2. Dashboard

The Dashboard is the home screen after login. It gives a top-level snapshot of the whole study at a glance:

- **KPI tiles** — total participants, how many started, completed, dropped off, submitted contact info, and where each stands in the debrief and interview pipeline.
- **Funnel visualization** — shows how participants move through each stage: landing page viewed → CTA clicked → study started → task completed → contact submitted → study completed → debrief completed → interview accepted. This is the fastest way to see where people are dropping off.
- **Recruitment source breakdown** — how participants are arriving (QR code shown on stream, chat-pinned link, stream description link, or a direct link) and which source is converting best.
- **Streamer performance table** — visits, conversions, and conversion rate broken down per partnered streamer.
- **Recent activity feed** — a live-ish list of the latest participant actions across the whole study.

TIP — Check the Dashboard first whenever you sit down to work — it tells you whether anything needs urgent attention (e.g. a big pending-debrief backlog) before you dive into a specific tab.

3. Experiments

Open [Experiments](#) from the sidebar, then click into your study to see its detail page, organized into tabs.

3.1 Overview tab

- Top-line stats: participant count, completion rate, number of conditions.
- **Description / Research Objective** — editable via the [Edit](#) button.
- **Assigned Streamers** — shows every partnered streamer with an [Assign](#) / [Unassign](#) toggle. A streamer must be assigned here before their tracking links or "Assigned Studies" view will show anything.
- **Timeline & Ethics Approval** — start/end dates and the IRB reference number for this study.
- **Status controls** — [Mark Completed](#) and [Archive](#) change the study's lifecycle state.
- **Danger zone** — [Delete Experiment](#) permanently removes the experiment and every participant, response, and event under it. There is no undo — only use this on a genuinely unwanted test experiment, never on the live study.

3.2 Conditions tab

Conditions are the different persuasion-cue combinations participants are randomly assigned to (e.g. Control, Urgency only, Social proof only, Full stimulus). Use [New Condition](#) to add one, or [Edit](#) on an existing card to change its cue toggles, reward rarity, or whether contact info is required or optional for that condition.

IMPORTANT — Editing a condition that already has real participants assigned to it changes what future participants experience under that name — it does not retroactively change what past participants already saw. Avoid editing conditions once real data collection has started, unless you specifically intend a mid-study change.

3.3 Participants tab (per-experiment)

A shortcut into the global Participants list (see Chapter 4), pre-filtered to this experiment only.

3.4 Surveys tab

Manage the post-task survey questions shown to participants who complete the study.

3.5 Streams tab

Each row is one live-stream session used for recruitment. Click [New Stream Session](#) to log a session — streamer, game, platform, stream title, start/end times, estimated viewer count, and whether a QR code or chat link was actually posted during that stream. [Edit](#) on an existing row updates those details.

3.6 Tracking Links tab

This is where you generate the actual links participants click to enter the study.

- 1 Click [Generate Link](#).
- 2 Pick the streamer this link is for (or leave unassigned for a generic link).
- 3 Pick the **entry source** — QR Code, Chat Link, Stream Description, Direct, or Other.
- 4 If you picked QR Code, Chat Link, or Stream Description, you must also pick which **stream session** this link belongs to — the platform will refuse to generate the link without one, since those three sources only make sense tied to a specific stream.
- 5 Click [Generate](#). The new short code appears in the table with its own visit/conversion counters.

3.7 Analytics tab

Deeper charts and breakdowns specific to this experiment — condition-by-condition comparisons and engagement metrics.

4. Participants

The global, cross-experiment participant roster, reachable from the sidebar.

4.1 Filtering & search

Every filter control has a visible label above it (Streamer, Entry Source, Study Status, Contact Submitted, Debrief Status, Data Use Permission, Interview Status, Research Eligibility, plus free-text search and a date range) so you can narrow the list down to exactly the slice you need before exporting or reviewing.

4.2 Participant detail page

Clicking any participant's anonymous code (e.g. `P-1001`) opens their full record, organized into sections:

Section	What it shows
Overview	Which experiment/condition they're in, which streamer/link brought them, current funnel stage, reward outcome.
Journey	A timeline of every event they triggered, in order — the fastest way to see exactly what a specific participant did.
Responses	Their answers to the post-task survey, if they completed one.
Contact	Their disclosed email/phone (encrypted at rest — only revealed on an explicit click), plus researcher follow-up state: contact status, assigned researcher, prize fulfillment, and a log of every contact attempt.
Debrief	Whether/how the ethics debrief was delivered and acknowledged.
Interview	Consent-to-interview status, scheduling, and interview record (mode, notes, themes) if one took place.
Research Decision	The final eligible/excluded call for this participant's data, with a reason and reviewer notes — this is what determines whether they count toward your final analysis sample.

5. Streamers

The roster of every partnered streamer, independent of any one experiment. From here you can:

- See each streamer's channel details, category, and status (Active/Inactive/Pending).
- Click into a streamer's detail page to see total clicks and every experiment they're currently assigned to.
- [Edit](#) their profile details, or [Delete](#) a streamer entirely (only do this for a genuinely inactive/test streamer — it does not delete their historical participant data, but removes them from future assignment).

6. Outreach

The human follow-up pipeline for anyone who submitted contact info — three tabs under one section, matching the natural sequence: contact → debrief → interview invite.

6.1 Contacts

Every participant who submitted an email or phone number appears here. For each row you can:

- Click **Reveal** to decrypt and view their contact details for that one lookup (never stored decrypted, never shown by default).
- Update their **contact status** (Not Contacted → Contacted → Debriefed → Interview Invited/Completed → Unreachable).
- **Assign** a researcher to own that follow-up.
- Set a **next follow-up date** and log the outcome of each **contact attempt** (Answered, No Answer, Wrong Number, Call Back Later, etc.) — every attempt is kept as a running log, not overwritten.
- Track **prize fulfillment** (Selected → Won → Claimed/Not Claimed → Delivered) and add free-text notes.

6.2 Debrief

This queue is for participants who need a manual ethics debrief follow-up — either because they haven't completed the automatic on-site debrief themselves, or a researcher needs to record how contact went. For each row you can set:

- **Debrief status** — Pending, Contacted, Explained, Acknowledged, Declined, or Unreachable.
- **Debrief method** — Phone Call, WhatsApp, SMS, or Other.
- **Mark sent now** — stamps the current time as when the debrief was delivered.
- Free-text notes on that participant's debrief.

TIP — A participant only appears in this queue once they've submitted contact info — someone who abandoned before that point has nothing to debrief by phone, so they won't show up here (this is expected, not a bug).

6.3 Interviews

Manage qualitative-interview candidates from a single "Manage" dialog per participant, split into three parts:

- **Consent & Status** — record whether they consented to an interview (Pending/Yes/No). Setting consent to **Yes** automatically syncs their candidate status to Accepted; you save this with its own **Save consent & status** button.

- **Schedule Interview** — pick a mode (phone, WhatsApp call, Google Meet, Zoom, in person, other), set the date/time, duration, and after the interview happens, fill in the summary, themes, and researcher notes.
- **Research Eligibility** — the same eligible/excluded decision described in Chapter 4, editable directly from this dialog too, with an exclusion reason and review notes.

7. Research Dataset

Where you get data out of the platform for analysis.

7.1 Exports

Five ready-made CSV downloads:

Export	Contains
Behavioral dataset	One row per participant — condition, funnel stage, timings, outcome. No phone numbers.
Survey responses	Every answer to every post-task survey question.
Engagement events	The full raw event log (page views, clicks, submissions) for detailed behavioral analysis.
Interview status	Consent, scheduling, and outcome for every interview candidate.
Contact export restricted	The only export that includes decrypted phone numbers/emails — handle this file with the same care as the source data itself.

7.2 Browse Tables

A raw, paginated view into any of the 13 underlying data tables (participants, sessions, events, responses, streamers, stream sessions, recruitment sources, contacts, debrief records, data-use permissions, interview consents, interviews, research eligibility). Pick a table from the dropdown, and a short note appears above the table explaining *what that specific table is useful for analyzing* — read that note before you start pulling numbers from a table, since it tells you the intended use directly.

8. Settings

8.1 Profile

Update your own researcher name and see your account email.

8.2 Stimulus Content

Edit every piece of text shown on the public participant-facing pages — hero headline/subtext, FAQ, trust badges, reward pool labels, game categories, and the debrief/entry-confirmation copy — without touching code. Changes go live immediately on save.

IMPORTANT — Once real data collection is underway, changing this content (especially the debrief/consent wording, which has already been through ethics review) can affect what different participants experienced and complicate analysis. Treat this page as locked once the study is live, unless a change is specifically required and cleared first.

8.3 Research Data Preferences

Two platform-wide toggles are shown here for visibility — "Require ethics reference for Active studies" and "Auto-delete declined participant contact data" — both enforced automatically across every experiment, not per-researcher settings.

PART TWO

Streamer Partner Portal

What a partnered streamer sees and can do once a researcher has assigned them to a study.

1. Logging In

Streamers log in at the same login page using the account credentials given to them by the research team. Successful login lands on the Streamer Dashboard.

2. Dashboard

A quick summary: how many studies you're assigned to, your total link clicks, and how many active tracking links you currently have.

3. Assigned Studies

Lists every study a researcher has assigned your channel to. If nothing appears here, a researcher hasn't assigned you to a study yet — reach out to them.

Click into a study to see:

- Your personal **tracking link code** for that study.
- Your **link visits** and **conversions** so far.
- **Study instructions** — exactly how and where to share the link during your stream (e.g. as an on-screen QR code, pinned in chat, or in the stream description) so that visits are correctly attributed to you.

IMPORTANT — Always share the link exactly as instructed and in the format the researcher gave you — sharing it a different way than the entry source it was generated for can cause your traffic to be miscounted.

4. Profile

Keep your display name, platform, channel URL, and category up to date — this is what the research team sees when assigning studies and reviewing performance.

LiveDrop Arena — internal platform guide. This document reflects the platform as of September 2026 and may be updated as features change.